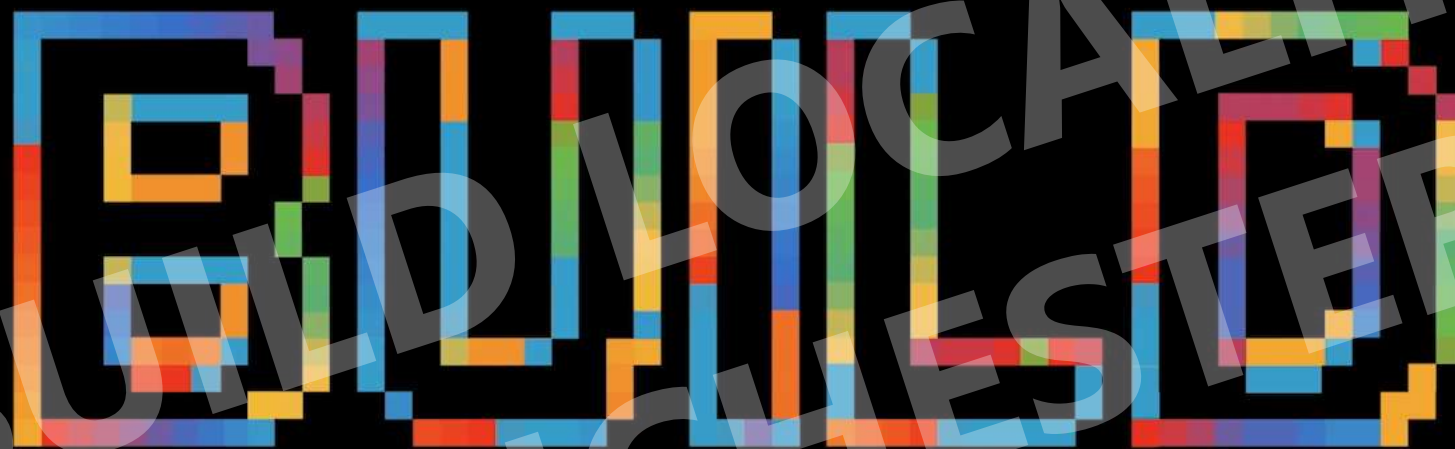
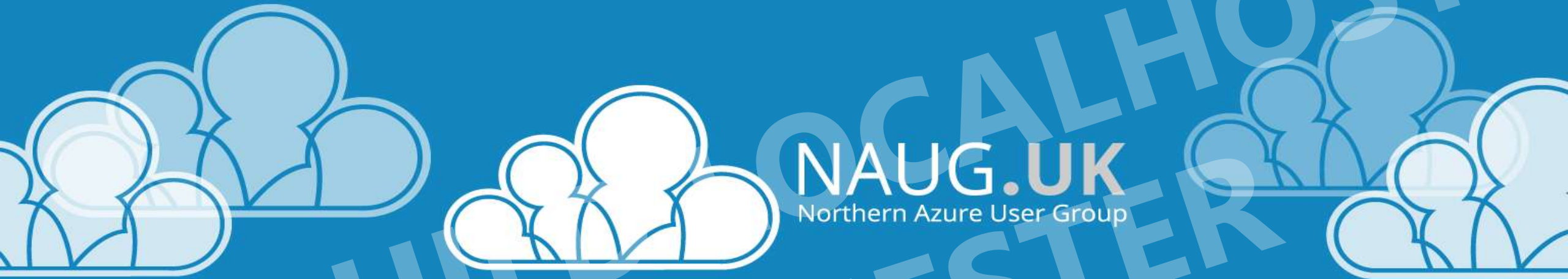




MICROSOFT BUILD

Northern Azure User Group



13th June 2026

BUILD



Housekeeping



NAUG.UK
Northern Azure User Group



- No fire alarms expected
- Help yourself to food/drinks
- Toilets are at reception
- Phones on silent please
- Thank you to ANS for hosting!

Community – Azure family

aka.ms/azurefamily



Azure Family - Azure User Groups around the world

- Home
- Africa User Groups
- Asia User Groups
- Canada User Groups
- Europe User Groups
- Germany User Groups
- Oceania User Groups
- RoW User Groups

Azure Family - Find your local user group

Welcome to a listing of the Azure User Groups that are located around the world.

This is an open source project, so if you are aware of a group that exists and isn't listed here, please look at contributing to the project and updating the list for others. If you are unsure how to contribute, I've put together a [small how-to guide](#) for you.

Getting involved with your local user group has a great many benefits, from helping you learn something new from a speaker to making new connections amongst the other attendees. There are a lot of different communities out there you can get involved in and this site is intended to help people find and participate in their Azure communities more easily.



NAUG.UK
Northern Azure User Group





● Live events happening across Manchester

Manchester Tech Events

The single source for Manchester's tech community. Discover meetups, founder dinners, AI demos and hackdays — all in one place.

[Browse events →](#)

[+ Add your event](#)

1000+

Community members

50+

Venues across the city

Weekly

New events curated



North West Tech Community

 @technwuk

 Calendar  Groups  Conferences  Elsewhere  Slack  Speakers  About

This is a public calendar. Feel free to use! Kept up to date by the organisers of the listed events.



Today

< > June 2026 ▾



SUN 31	MON 1 Jun	TUE 2	WED 3	THU 4	FRI 5	SAT 6
					● 6pm Software Lancaster	
7	8	9	10	11	12	13
		● 6pm DotNetNorth		● 7pm NetMCR		
14	15	16	17	18	19	20
				● 6:30pm NWRUG - North West Ru	● 6pm Software Lancaster	
21	22	23	24	25	26	27
28	29	30	1 Jul	2	3	4

Social – get in touch



NAUG.UK
Northern Azure User Group



hello@naug.co.uk



northernazureug.bsky.social



Northern Azure User group



6BC9jAWuH



Feedback



NAUG.UK
Northern Azure User Group



bitly

bit.ly/Naug-feedback



//LOCALHOST:MANCHESTER





MICROSOFT BUILD



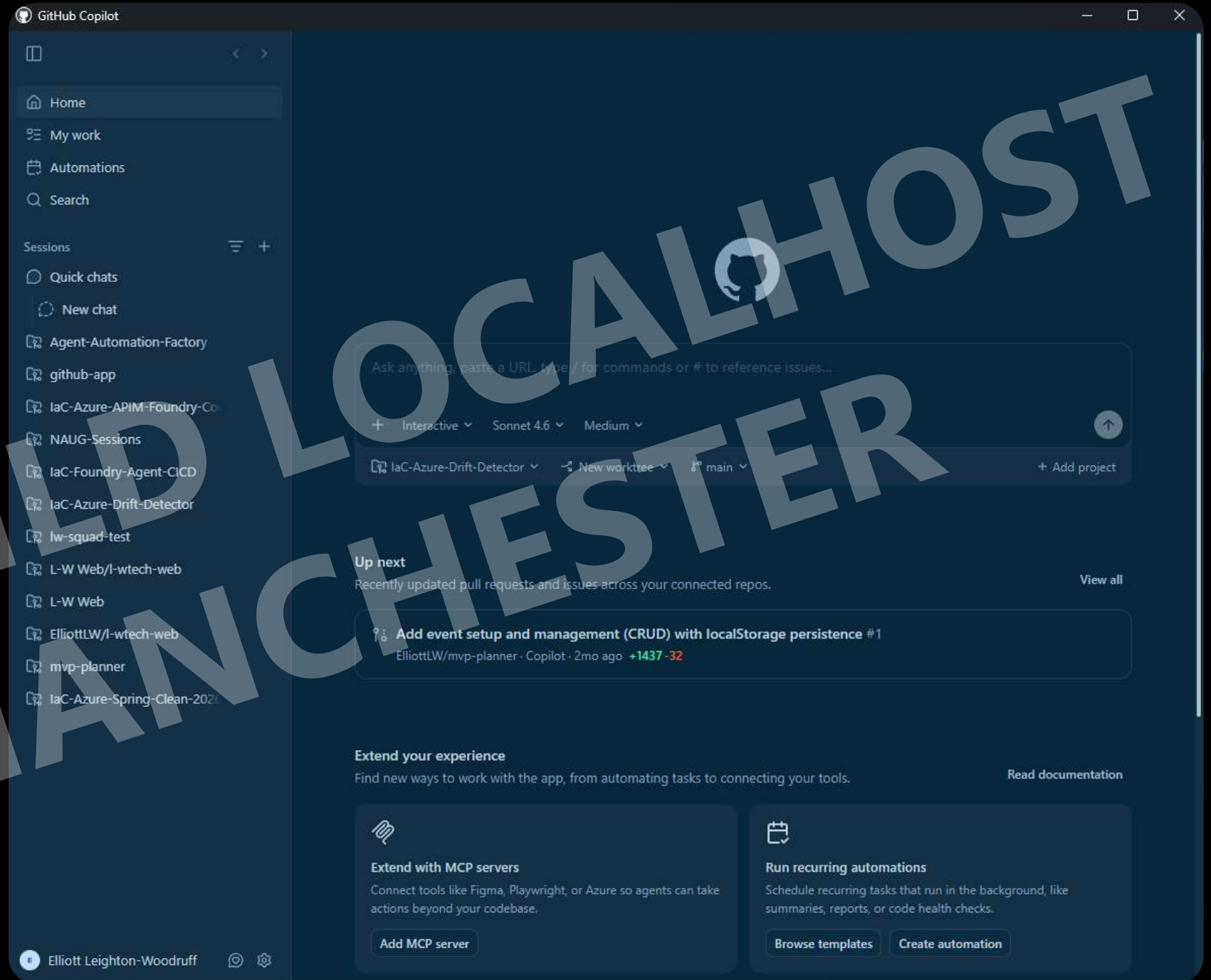
In-house Microsoft AI models

Majorana 2

Microsoft IQ (Work + Foundry + Fabric IQ)

Surface RTX Spark Dev Box & **Ultra**

Github Copilot App



Microsoft Scout

MICROSOFT BUILD

Thank you for coming.....

MSBUILD LOCALHOST
MANCHESTER



Agenda

- Cloud Platform and Data Update
- Containers Without the Complexity
- Custom agents in Functions
- Securing Azure access for devs with AVD
- Sovereign AI with Microsoft Foundry
- Break
- Hands-on Lab! Zero to AI Agents 🤖
- Networking



Cloud Platform and Data Update

Nicholas Chang



Containers Without the Complexity

Nathan Heptinstall



Agenda

- Why Containers?
- The Adoption Problem
- Containerisation and AKS announcements
- Demo: Creating and app containerising
- Demo: Azure Container Apps Express
- Demo: Deploying a Cluster
- Demo: AKS Desktop

Why Containers?

Portability

- Complexity and the skills gap remain the top barriers to wider adoption

Immutability

- Containers are not patched in place, they're replaced

Workloads

- Web Apps, APIs, Background Workers, Microservices, MCP Servers, etc

Reliability/Resilience

- AKS Health probes - Restart failed containers, rebalance workloads, perform rolling updates with zero downtime.

Security & Isolation

- Each container runs in its own isolated process space with its own filesystem, network, and resource limits

Consistency

- Identical across dev, test, staging, and production.

Speed

- Containers start in milliseconds. Faster deployments, faster scaling, faster recovery

Resource Efficiency

- Share the host OS kernel. Run significantly more workloads on the same hardware compared to virtual machines

The Adoption Problem – The Kubernetes Overhead

High barrier to entry

- Complexity and the skills gap remain the top barriers to wider adoption

Expertise gap

- Meaningful use requires knowledge of networking (CNI, ingress, egress, DNS), RBAC, storage, scaling policies, and cluster lifecycle management

Tool fragmentation

- kubectl, dashboards, monitoring stacks, CI/CD pipelines, and cloud portals simultaneously

YAML sprawl

- Every deployment, service, ingress, config map, and secret requires hand-authored manifests

Build 2026 Containerisation Announcements

WSL Containers (WSLC)

- Run Linux containers directly on Windows
- Developers can now run Linux containers directly via wslc.exe
- WSL container API - use Linux containers in app logic in Windows apps

Azure Local on small form factor hardware

- Runs Azure Linux directly on bare metal OEM hardware (no virtualization layer) to host containers
- Choose container a runtime: Docker, open-source k3s, or fully managed AKS
- Managed from the Azure portal

Other Recent Containerisation Announcements

Azure Container Apps Express

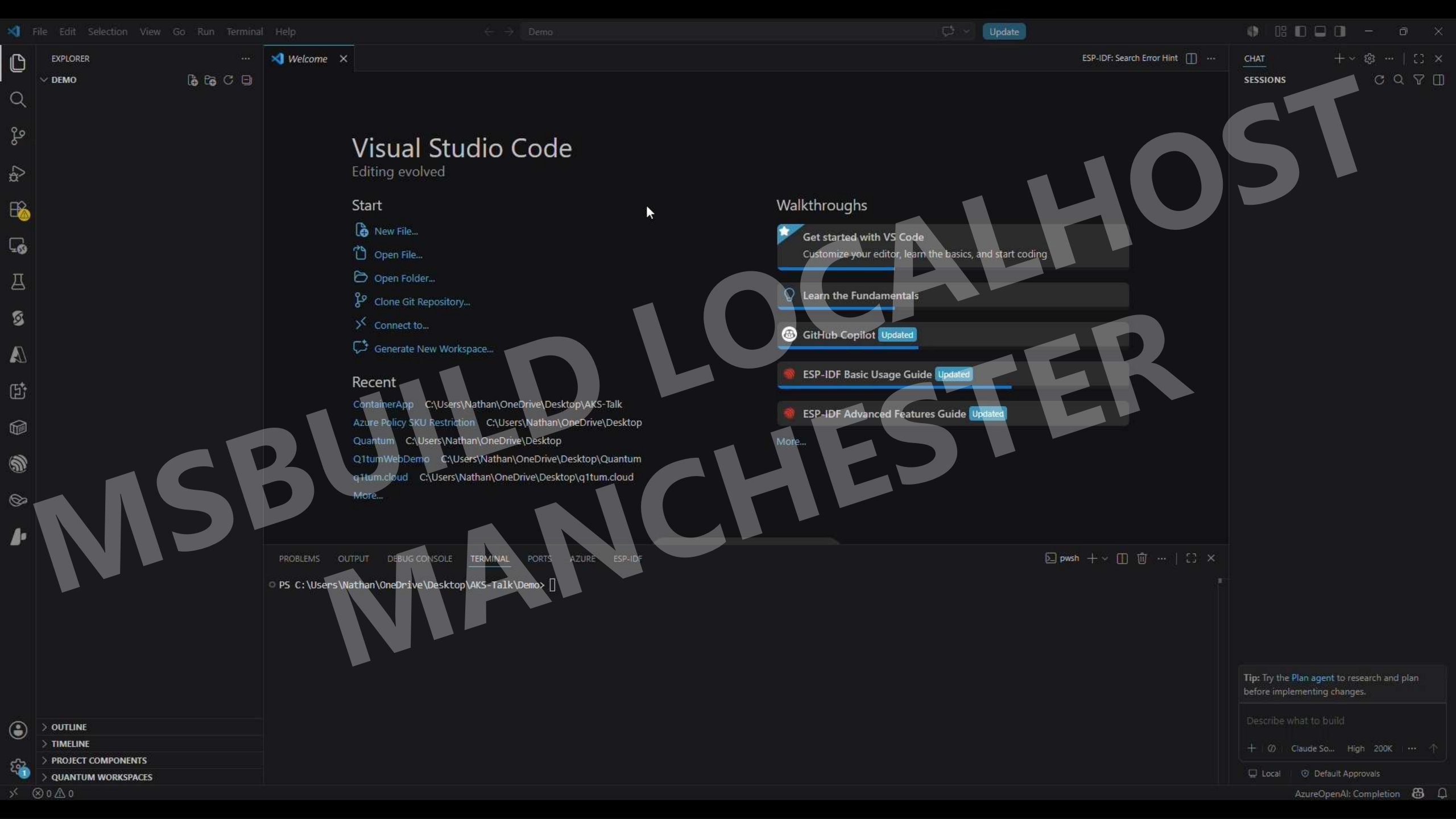
- In Preview - officially announced on 13 May 2026
- It's easy to remove bullets
- The fastest way to deploy containerized web applications to Azure

AKS Desktop

- An application-focused developer portal for AKS that simplifies application deployment

Demo

Creating and containerising an app



Azure Container Apps Express - Features

- Zero infrastructure decisions
- Instant provisioning
- No networking to configure
- Opinionated defaults: scaling, compute allocation, cold-start optimisation
- Scale to zero, consumption-based pricing
- New ACA 'Express' Environment
- Public preview and limited to West Central US and East Asia regions
- No private networking options
- No Managed Identity or Auth support

ACA Express – Doesn't Support Registry Auth

Don't try this at home – well you might have to if you want to try ACA Express with you own containers...

Anonymous Pull

```
az acr update --name ansaksacr --anonymous-pull-enabled true
```


Demo

Azure Container Apps Express

AKS Desktop (Preview)

- AKS Cluster SKUs/Automatic multi-cluster management
- Application-centric management
- Projects group deployments, services, and config into a single unit
- Natural language troubleshooting
- Guided workflows
- View logs, metrics, health status, and dependency maps in one place.
- Insights (Inspektor Gadget) no code changes - Processes, Trace TCP, Trace DNS
- RBAC

Demo

Deploying an AKS Cluster



```
PowerShell 7 (x64) X + -  
PS C:\Users\Nathan\OneDrive\Desktop\AKS-Talk\Demo> |
```

MSBUILD LOCALHOST
MANCHESTER

Demo

Installing and Configuring AKS Desktop

Home

Notifications

Settings

nathan.heptinstall

Add Cluster

Home

All Clusters Projects

☐	Name ↑	Origin	Status	Warnings	Kubernetes Version	Actions
☐	aks-cluster	Kubeconfig: C:\Users\Nathan\.kube\config	Active	4	v1.34.7	

Thanks for listening!

MSBUILD LOCALHOST
MANCHESTER





Running Custom Agents inside Function Apps

Curtis Milne





Securing Azure Access for Devs with AVD

Donny Walsh



Allow myself to introduce...myself

Donny Walsh

Lead Azure Consultant @ ANS



Securing Azure Access for Developers with AVD

A controlled, identity-first workspace model for productive access to private Azure resources.



One governed path for identity, workspace, private network access and developer tooling.

Problem:
How to
keep
access
secure?



The developer access challenge

Developers need fast, secure Azure access - but the access path must stay controlled

The problem isn't access.

It's where trust, secrets and network reach are allowed to live.

Endpoint variance

Different devices, locations and networks

Local exposure

Credentials, certs, code or data stored on laptops

Public reach

Private services need restricted network access

Supplier access

Contractors are harder to govern consistently

Avoid extending the trusted boundary to every laptop



Security teams need auditability, least privilege and central control — without slowing delivery.

The laptop should be the access device - not the trusted execution environment.

AVD as a secure developer workspace

Move the trusted developer workstation into Azure

AVD becomes the governed execution environment for Azure tools, credentials and network access.



Centralised control

Harden, monitor and patch session hosts consistently.

Identity first

Use Entra ID, MFA and Conditional Access at entry.

Reduced laptop risk

Keep sensitive tools and data inside Azure sessions.

Standard tooling

Deliver approved dev tools and baseline config.

Secure reverse-connect: Session hosts establish outbound connectivity to the AVD service - no inbound RDP exposure.

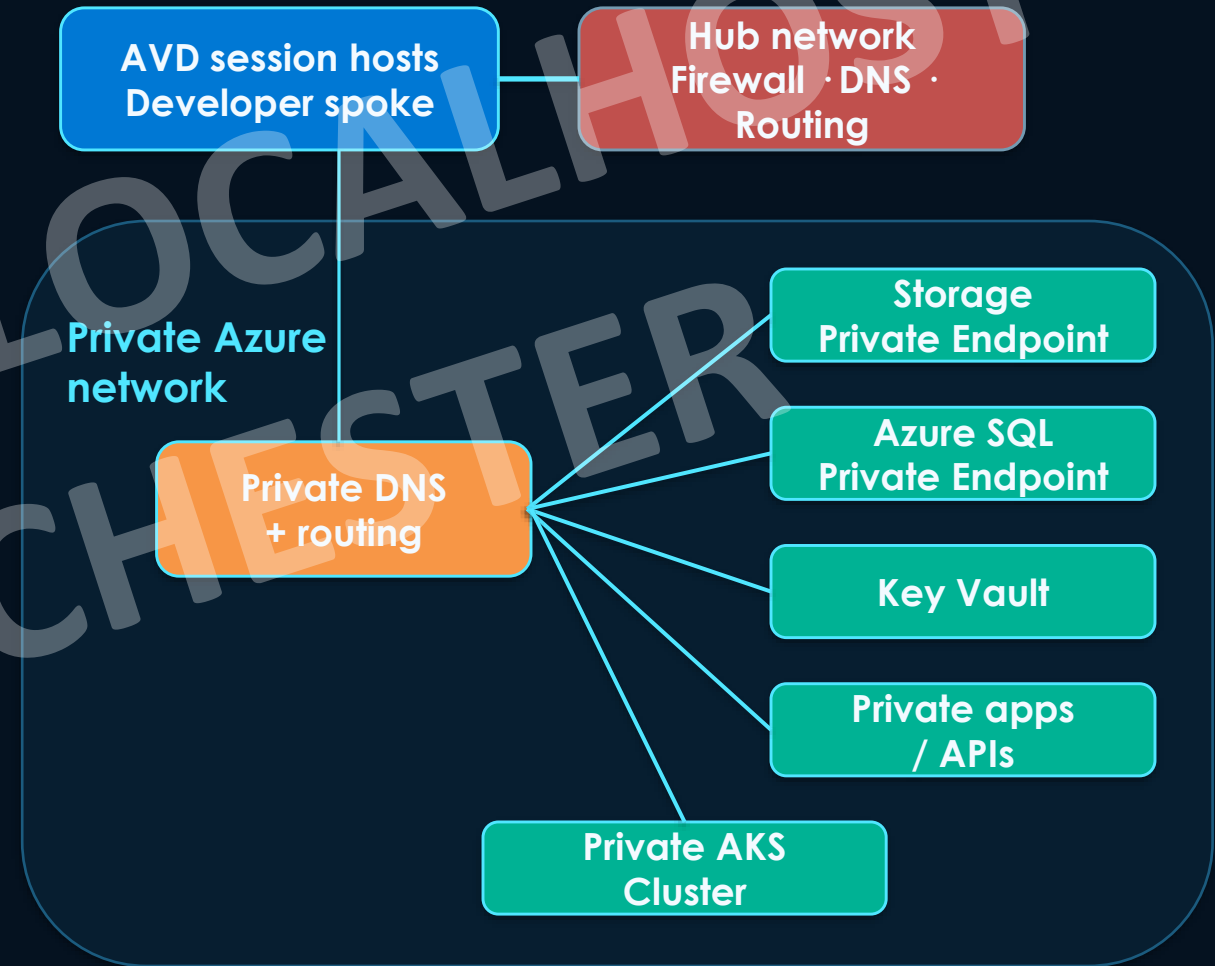
Secure access to Azure services

Put developers close to services - without exposing those services publicly

Private paths by design

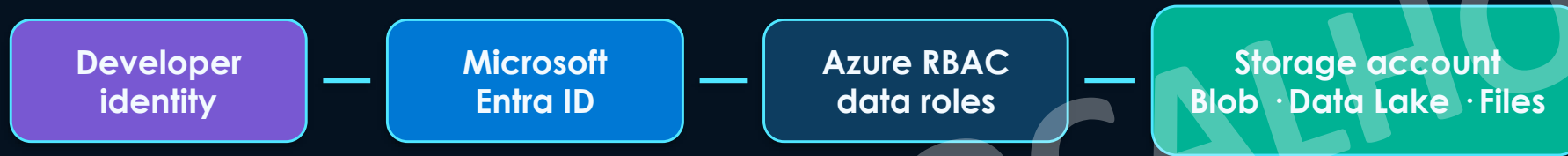
- Run Portal, CLI, DevOps, database and API tooling from AVD
- Use Private Endpoints for PaaS services
- Keep traffic on private Azure network paths where possible
- Avoid broad public firewall exceptions for developer laptops

Laptop connects to AVD. AVD connects privately to Azure services.



Entra ID authentication for storage

Use identity and RBAC instead of storage keys or unnecessary domain dependencies



Security principles

No shared keys

Least-privilege RBAC

Auditable identity
access

Cloud-only option for
Azure Files

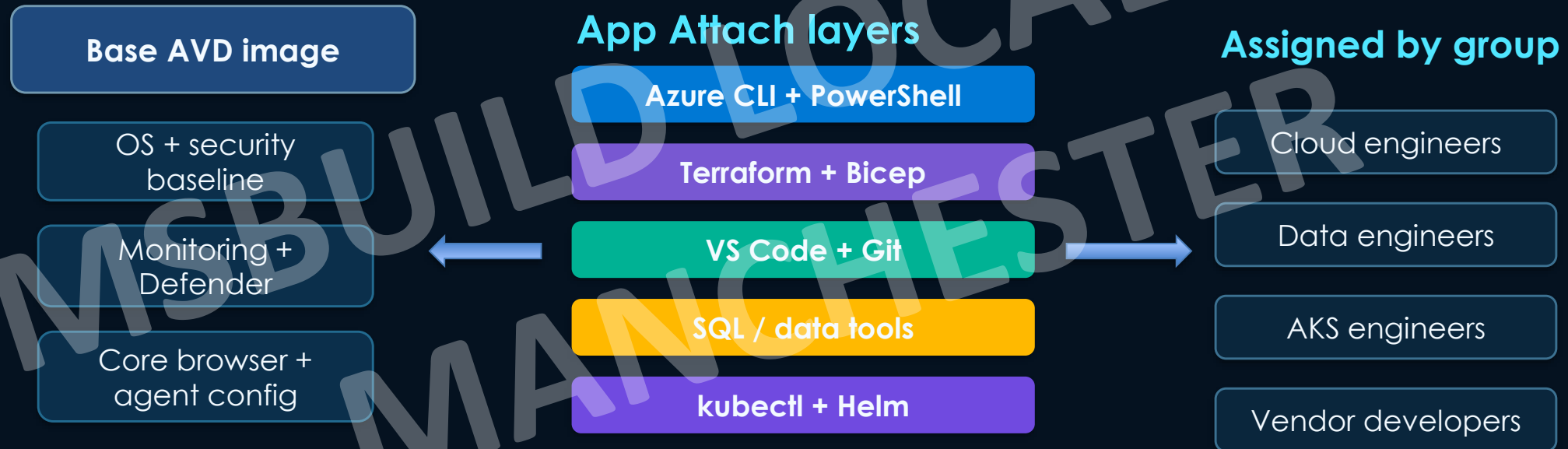
- Blob/Data Lake: authorise access using Entra ID and Azure RBAC
- Azure Files SMB: Microsoft Entra Kerberos can support Entra-based access
- For cloud-only users, Azure Files no longer needs a domain controller for auth/authz
- AVD provides a controlled workstation for identity-based storage access

App Attach for developer tooling

Keep the base image clean and deliver tools dynamically by role or project

One hardened image, many toolsets

Apps are attached to the user session instead of baked into every session host image.



Assign toolsets by user or project, support version variance and reduce golden-image sprawl.

Recommended secure access model

Secure, productive Azure access without trusting every endpoint equally



Access device

Laptop reaches AVD; it does not host secrets, keys or privileged tooling.

Identity gate

Entra ID, MFA, Conditional Access, PIM and least-privilege RBAC govern entry.

Controlled workspace

Azure tools run from a hardened, monitored AVD session host.

Private access

Private Endpoints, private DNS and controlled routing protect Azure services.

Key takeaways

AVD gives developers a secure place to work in Azure. App Attach provides the right tools. Entra ID and Private Endpoints keep access controlled, auditable and private.

Crisis
Averted



COFFEE

ESPRESSO	2.50
AMERICANO	2.75
CAPPUCCINO	3.25
LATTE	3.50
MOCHA	3.75
FLAT WHITE	3.50
COLD BREW	3.75
TEA	2.50

"So many worlds,
so little time."
— Rincewind

BOOKS
&
BEANS

BOOKS
COFFEE
GOOD TIMES

TAXI



Sovereign AI with Microsoft Foundry

Joshua Musiyarira



Time for a break

MSBUILD LOCALHOST
MANCHESTER



From zero to deployed on Azure with AI agents

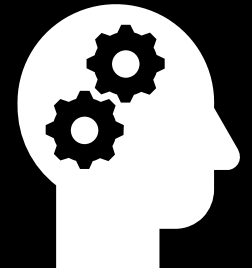
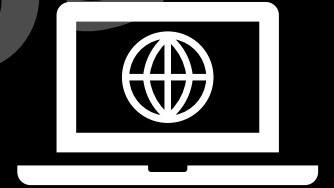
Elliott Leighton-Woodruff



Lets get setup!

Lab Environment

- Skillable lab environment
- No Azure credentials or tenant/subscription needed
- You will need access to a device, feel free to team up
- Recommend you use a personal account



github.com/ElliottLW/build



Get the most out of your training.

Sign In

Register with Training Key



MICROSOFT BUILD

From zero to deployed on Azure with AI agents

End

Instructions Resources

From zero to deployed on Azure with AI agents

Welcome to Your Lab Environment

Note: Text formatted as an `example` represents type text. Clicking on this text will automatically insert it to prevent any typing errors.

To begin, log into the virtual machine using the following credentials: `Pa$$w0rd`

For lab instructions, navigate to: <https://github.com/microsoft/Build26-LAB501-from-zero-to-deployed-on-azure-with-ai-agents/tree/main/docs/lab-instructions>

`https://github.com/microsoft/Build26-LAB501-from-zero-to-deployed-on-azure-with-ai-agents/tree/main/docs/lab-instructions`

The Azure account credentials for this lab are available in the **Resources** tab above.

Helpful Links:

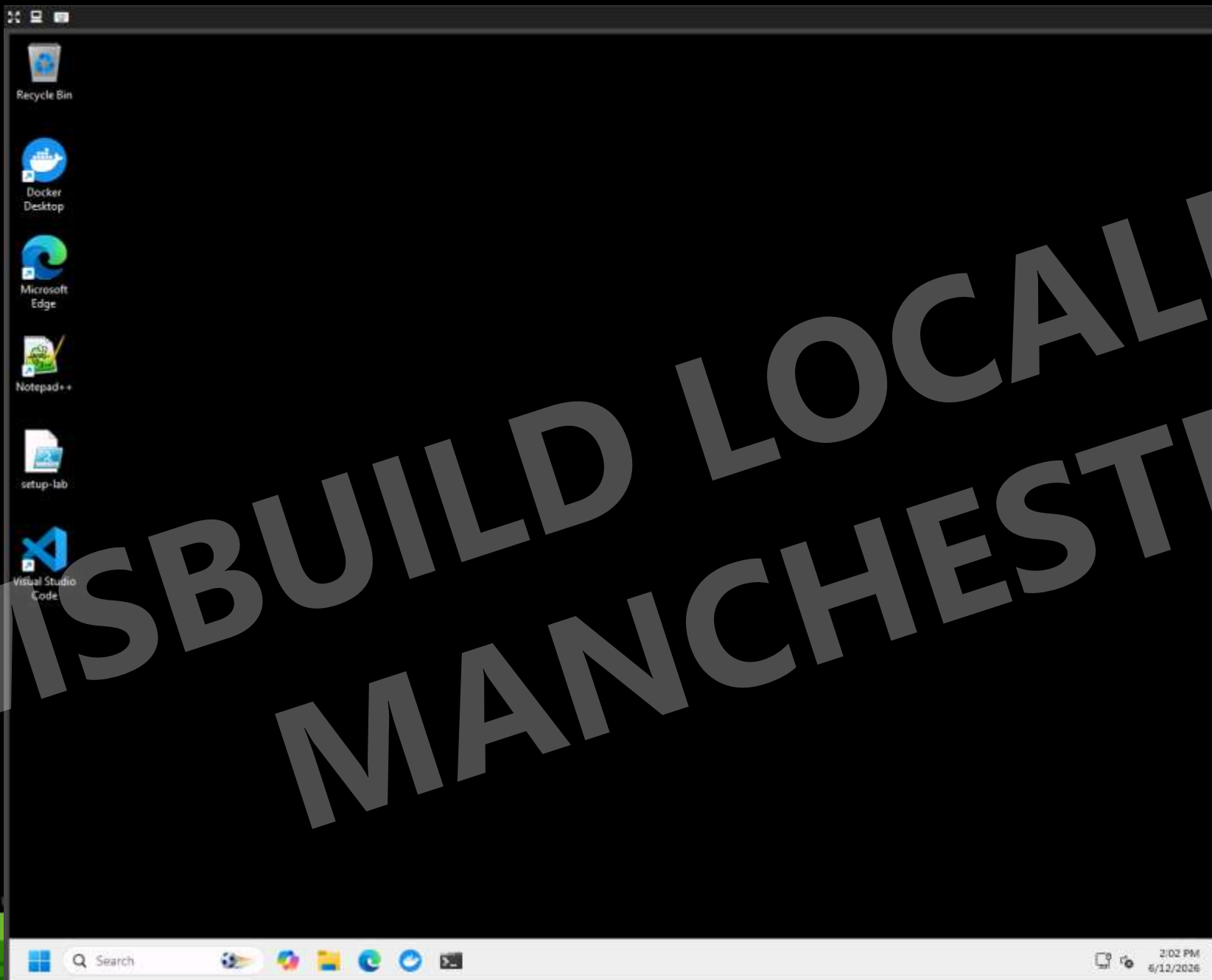
`https://github.com/enterprises/skillable-events/sso`

`https://mermaid.live`

← Previous

End →

2 Hours Remaining



Login & Launch

Azure

Azure Developer CLI

GitHub + Copilot

Powershell/Web

```
az login
```

```
azd auth login
```

```
https://github.com/enterprises/skillable-events/sso
```

Copilot

```
/login
```

Update the settings.json for Copilot CLI to disable rubber duck with this, "builtInAgents": {"rubberDuck": false},

```
/plugin marketplace add microsoft/azure-skills  
/plugin install azure@azure-skills  
/mcp reload
```

GitHub Copilot Setup

Disable Rubberduck Agent
Azure Skills Plugin



Set Up the Starter App

Clone the Lab Repo

Copy the Starter App



Powershell/Web

```
git clone https://github.com/microsoft/Build26-LAB501.git
cd Build26-LAB501
Copy-Item -Recurse src lego-set-browser
cd lego-set-browser
git init
git add -A
git commit -m "init"
```

Powershell/ Github Copilot

copilot --yolo

Deploy my env...

curl <your-endpoint-url>

Review my env...



Ship & Harden

Ship it

Verify

Harden



See It & Evaluate It

Generate the Diagram

Evaluate the Diagram

GitHub Copilot

Visualize the resources in my resource group as an architecture diagram.

What's missing from this architecture for a production deployment? The app also connects to an existing Cosmos DB for its data.



```
az containerapp ingress update --name <app> -g <rg> --target-port  
9999
```

My Container App is returning 503. What's wrong?

```
az containerapp ingress update --name <app> -g <rg> --target-port  
8000
```

Break & Triage

Make it fail

Diagnose with AI

Fix it

Investigate & operationalise

Post-Mortem

Operationalise

GitHub Copilot

Query the Log Analytics workspace for my Container App. Show me what happened during the port mismatch incident.

Create a KQL alert rule that fires when ProbeFailed events appear in the Container App system logs.

What other alert rules should I have for a production Container App backed by Cosmos DB?

From zero to deployed on
Azure with AI agents



Thank you for making today a success!



Thank you for your feedback

See you June 23rd

bit.ly/Naug-feedback



NAUG.UK
Northern Azure User Group